



Create a cute picture of Storyboarding for my HCI class [Gemini AI]

CSE472: HCI – Human Computer Interaction

Lecture – 9: Storyboarding
Spring 2026



Inspiring Excellence

Storytelling

- Stories are an effective and inexpensive way to capture, relate, and explore user experiences in the design process.
- Two methods for storytelling:
 1. Written scenarios
 - Written accounts and narratives of an experience
 2. Storyboards
 - Visual storytelling with rough sketches/cartoons/comics

Scenarios

- Short, written stories about people using technology in context
- They use narrative as a design tool
- Allow the user to imagine themselves in a particular situation
 - Similar to books
 - Imagination plays a role
- Use **personas** as characters to develop empathy

Components of a Scenarios

- Motivation
 - What prompted the persona to embark on the scenario?
- Context
 - Where is the person while the scenario is taking place? Does it change? Who else and where else is involved?
- Distractions
 - What kinds of distractions or interruptions typically occur and how does the persona deal with them?
- Goal
 - What is the persona's goal? Information seeking? An artifact?
 - An emotion?

Scenario Example

- Mr. and Mrs. Rahman are retired government schoolteachers in their late 60s. They live on their pension and a small savings account. After their children moved out, they recently sold their old family home in Rajshahi and shifted to a small rented apartment closer to the city center.
- One of the important tasks they need to complete after moving is updating their **Government Pension Management System (iBAS++)** profile with their new address so that their pension documents and notifications reach the right place. They are not sure where the nearest government service center (UISC/Union Digital Center) or pension office is located, and walking long distances has become difficult for them.
- Their son, Imran, lives in Dhaka and encouraged them to try doing the address update online using the **Pension Portal** or **MyGov** services instead of going physically. Last year, he bought them a laptop and taught them how to use Facebook, YouTube, and how to search for information on Google.
- However, Mr. and Mrs. Rahman have never visited a government service portal before. They don't know how the pension website is organized or what steps are required to update an address. They are worried about entering personal information online—such as NID number, phone number, or pension ID—because they have heard stories about online scams and fake websites.
- If the online service is **easy, trustworthy, and safe**, they would like to use it. But they need reassurance that they're on the official website, and they need guidance that feels simple and friendly. They want to know whether the system will clearly explain what to do and confirm that their new address has been updated successfully.

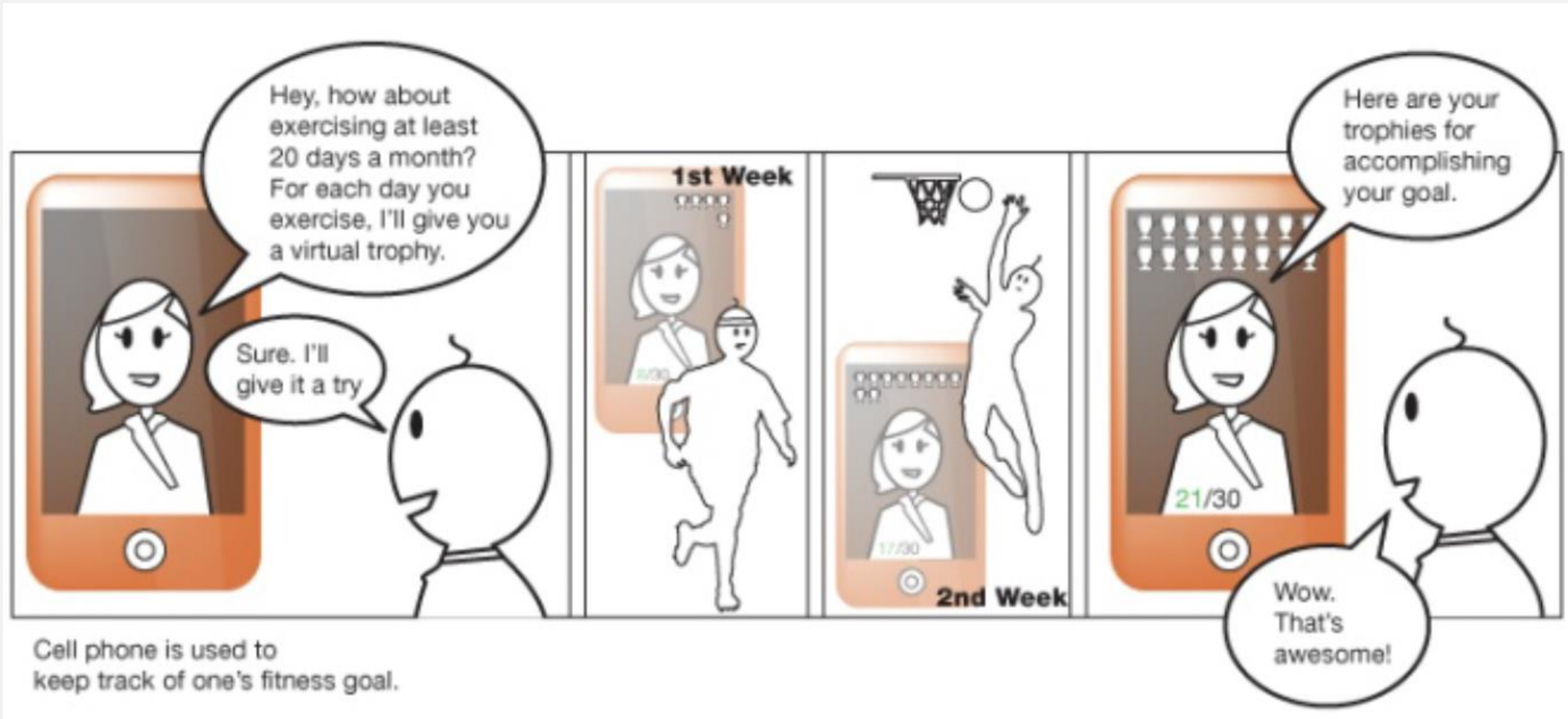
Storyboarding

- Storyboards are illustrations that represent a story.
 - Images are arranged together to visualize the story.
 - Invented by Walt Disney in the 1920s.
- Visual storytelling with rough sketches/cartoons/comics.
 - A great way to bring a story to life!
- Storyboards can be used to:
 - Describe a user's current situation (pre or post design).
 - Describe a user's hypothetical experience using a new technology/design.

Storyboarding

- Storyboarding is NOT the same as Paper Prototyping!
- We will cover Paper Prototyping next lecture!

Storyboarding Example



Storyboarding

Challenges:

- Determining WHAT to draw is often hard
 - Drawing the wrong thing puts the focus on the wrong thing
- Can be challenging to represent some things
 - e.g., time, attention

Usefulness:

- If done right, storyboards can give you quick, valuable feedback on early ideas
- MUCH quicker/easier than building the whole app, system, or prototype

Storyboarding

Goal: Understand how your product or application fits into a larger context.

- Show a single scenario / tell a single story
- Use different storyboards to tell different stories
- Start by setting the stage:

Who? What? Where? Why? When?

- Then show key interactions
- Zoom back out and show the consequences of using the system/design/application

Could be satisfaction, but also think about errors

How to make a Storyboard?

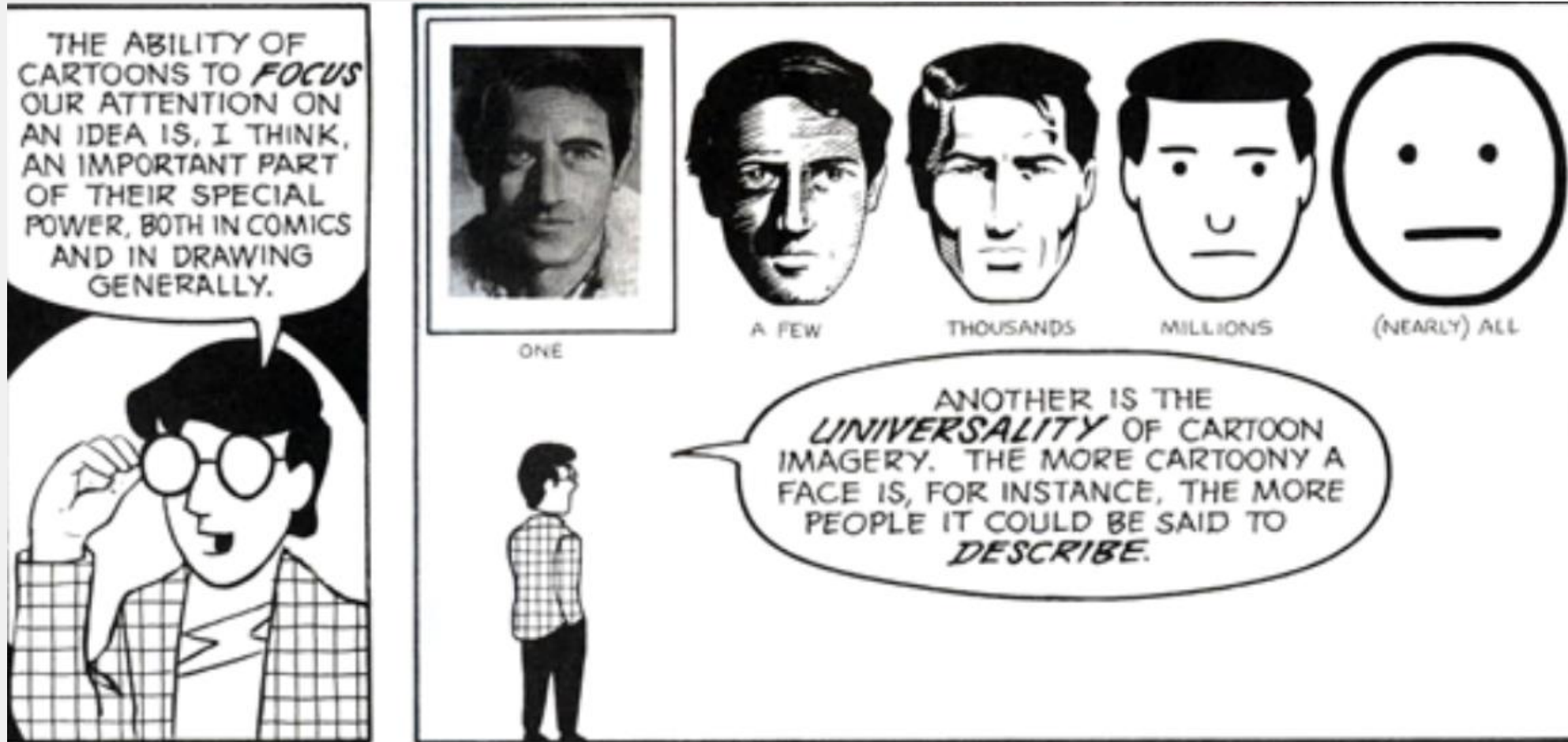
- Figure out the story you want to tell
 - Iterative process with lots of drafts
- Do a lot of brainstorming
- Define a scenario and break it into segments
 - Start with simple text (captions) and arrows
 - Add emotions
 - THEN sketch visuals on paper
- Generate more polished versions only when you have refined / finalized the story!

Elements of a Storyboard

Five key elements:

1. Level of detail
2. Inclusion of text
3. Inclusion of people (personas!) and emotions
4. Number of frames
5. Portrayal of time

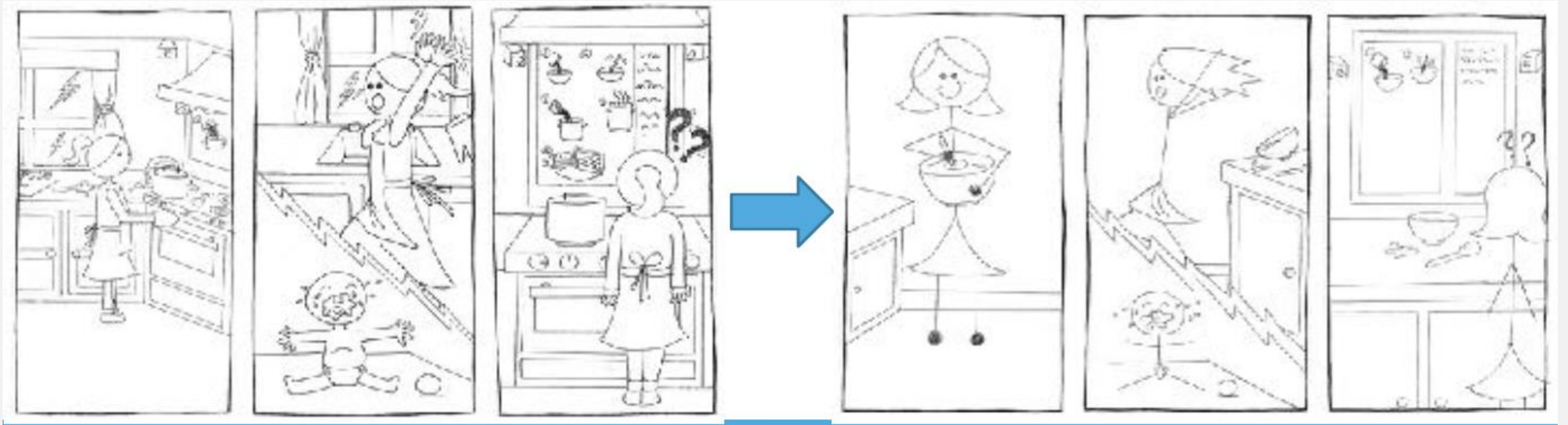
1. How much detail?



Caution: Too much detail can lose universality!

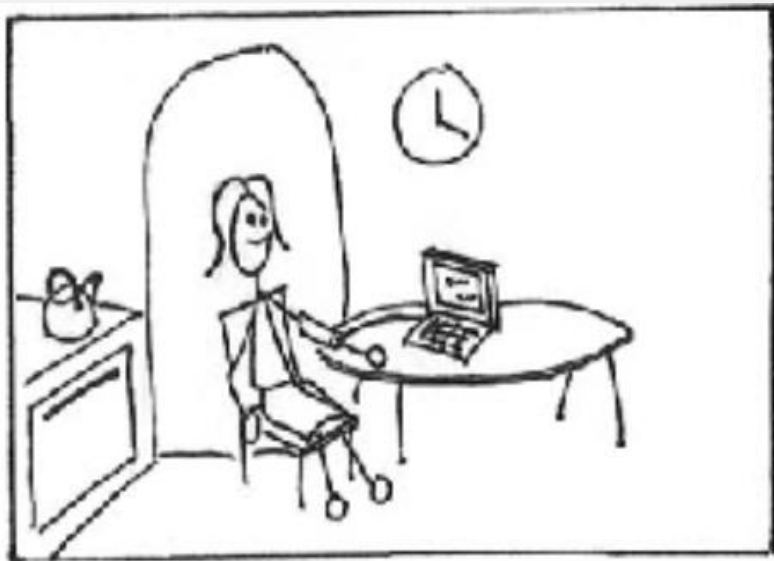
1. How much detail?

- I can't draw!!
 - Drawing is hard... But it doesn't have to be
 - Spending too much time drawing details is unnecessary

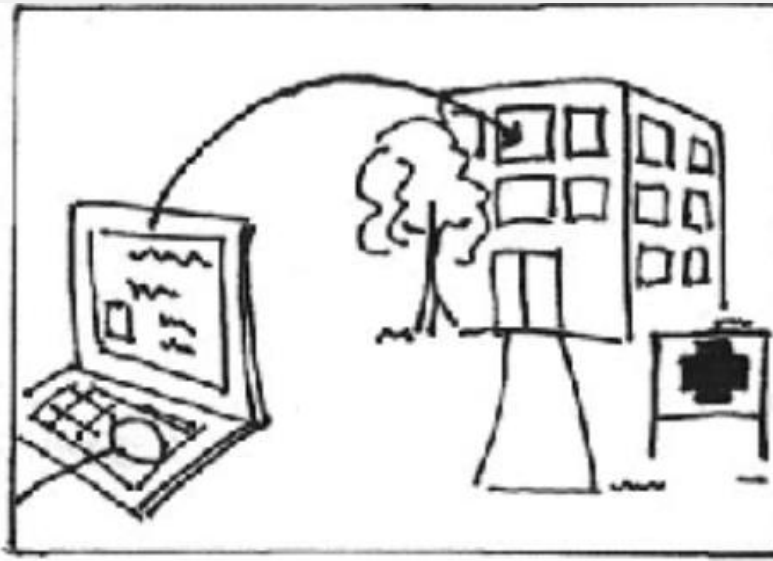


2. Use of Text

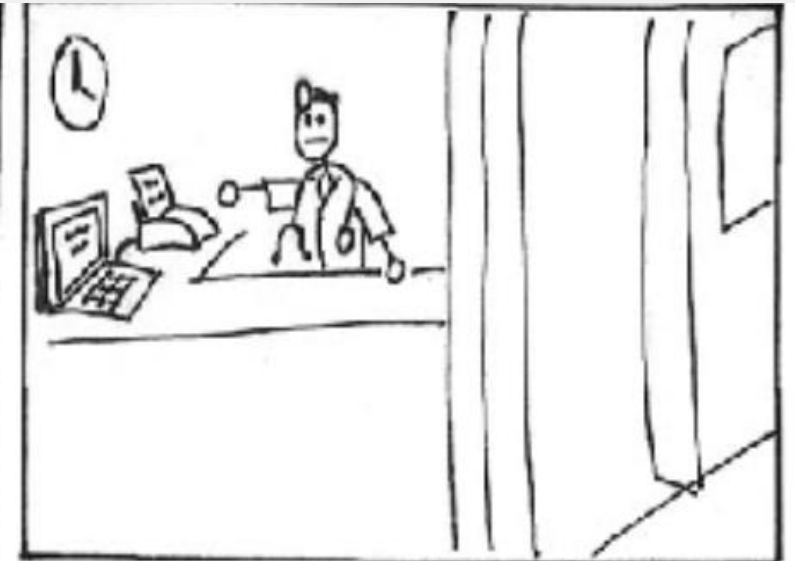
It is often necessary, and captions help
BUT... keep it short!



1. At home, Mary checks her blood pressure.



2. After a few simple key presses, her blood pressure readings get sent to a clinic.



3. The information is made available to her doctor.

3. Include People and Emotions

- The point of storyboards is to convey the experience of using the system!
- Include people experiencing the task/situation/design and their reactions to it.... Both good and bad!

Use personas!

4. How many frames?

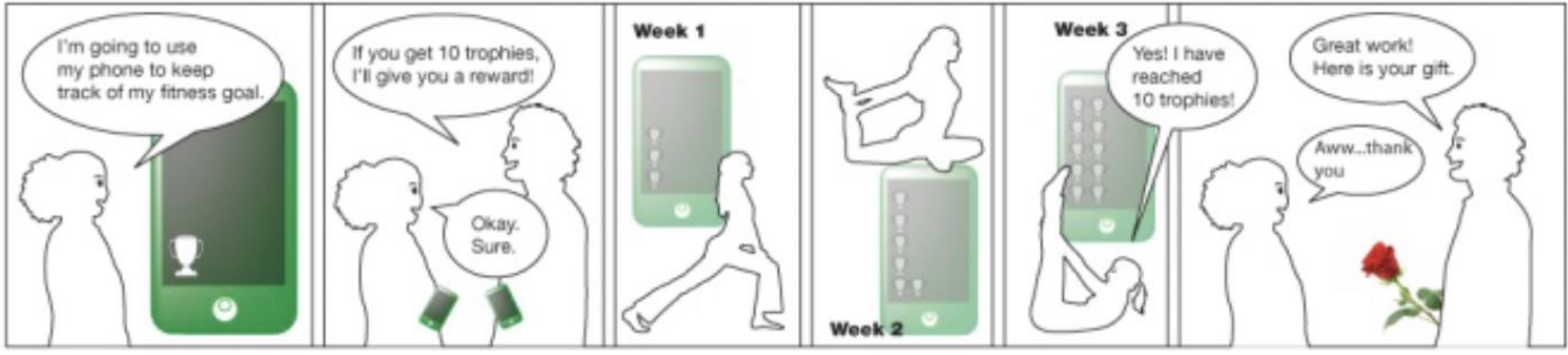
- Generally speaking, try to use fewer frames (e.g., 4-6 frames per story)
- More is not always better
 - May lose focus of the story
 - May lose reader's attention
- Limit it to the important steps
- Other advantages of short storyboards:
 - Less work on the designer
 - Forces you to succinctly tell the story / what really matters

4. How many frames?



5. Passage of Time

- Only include it if it is a necessary part of the story!



Making Drawing easier...

- Ok ok....It doesn't have to (always) be drawing!



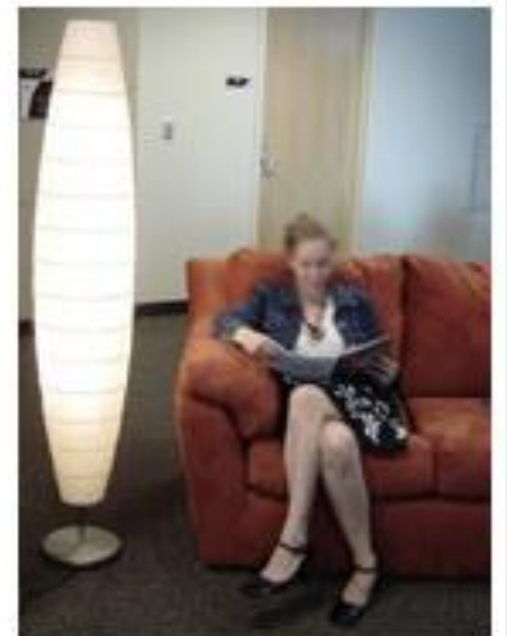
IT IS SO DARK JANE CAN
HARDLY READ HER BOOK



SHE GESTURES IN FRONT OF HER
SPECIAL PENDANT TO TURN ON
THE LIGHTS



THE LIGHTS TURN ON!



FINALLY, SHE CAN
READ HAPPILY.

Storyboards: Frames



Summary

- Storyboards are a great way to bring a story to life.
 - Good for pitching/communicating ideas
- Describe a user's current situation.
- Describe a user's hypothetical experience using a new technology/design.
- Make different versions of your storyboards
- Explore different options for presenting sequences of drawings
- Think carefully about what you want to tell / achieve
 - The wrong storyboard puts the focus on the wrong thing!

Reading

- Storyboarding in UX Design: <https://uxplanet.org/storyboarding-in-ux-design-b9d2e18e5fab>

Any questions?